

User Guide

The complete guide to every screen, calculation and tool.

Version 2.0

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1. What this tool is (and isn't)

Menu Margin Analyzer takes the selling price, ingredient cost, monthly units sold and monthly units wasted for each dish on your menu, plus optional labour and overhead figures for the business as a whole, and turns them into gross profit, food cost percentage, net profit, break-even revenue, and a plain-language read on which dishes are working, which need attention, and roughly how much a fix could be worth.

It's a modelling tool, not an accounting system. Every “potential improvement” or “net profit” figure it shows is a projection based on the numbers you enter, not a guarantee — use it to prioritise where to look, then verify before you act.

2. Installing and opening the app

Unzip the download to a folder, then open index.html in any modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox, Safari). The entire application — layout, styling and logic — lives in that single file; there are no other files it depends on.

Opening index.html directly from inside a zip-file preview window, without extracting first, can load a broken temporary copy in some file managers. Always extract the zip fully to a folder first, then open index.html from there.

The first time you open the app with no menu saved, you can start from a blank menu or click **Try sample menu** for a ready-made seven-dish example — including one dish deliberately priced below its ingredient cost, to show the Loss category in action.

3. The six screens

The app is organised into six screens, reached from the sidebar (desktop) or the bottom navigation bar (phone/narrow window):

- **Overview** — your menu's health at a glance: your biggest single opportunity, a KPI strip (revenue, gross profit, food cost, dishes analysed), a Strong / Grow / Optimise / Review / Loss health bar, and a “what deserves attention” priority list. Your target food cost, restaurant name and reporting period (used on printed reports) are also set here.
- **Menu** — the full dish table and cards (add, edit, confirm and remove dishes here), the Profit Map, Sales mix analysis, Purchasing analysis, the Ingredient library, Menu versions, Compare versions and Historical profitability.
- **Insights** — every confirmed dish as its own card, ranked most urgent first, plus a dedicated Price-change candidates table and a Margin target tool.
- **Scenarios** — pick any dish and test a different price, ingredient cost or sales volume (independently or together) to see the modelled effect, without touching your actual menu.
- **Action plan** — one concrete, checkable step per dish that needs it, in priority order, so you have a to-do list rather than another wall of data.
- **Profit control** — the whole business's profitability: labour, overheads and waste set against gross profit to produce net profit and a break-even revenue figure.

Import CSV, Export CSV, Export action list and Print report sit outside these six, in the sidebar on desktop. On a phone or narrow window, Import and Export move to the top bar; Export action list and Print report are currently only available at desktop width (see section 19, Troubleshooting).

4. Draft dishes vs. confirmed dishes

Click **+ Add dish** on the Menu screen to open a draft: name, selling price, ingredient cost (or a recipe — see section 14), monthly units sold, and monthly units wasted (optional). Drafts don't count anywhere in the analysis, so you can experiment freely. Click **Confirm dish** once the numbers are right, and it joins every screen's calculations immediately.

To change a confirmed dish, open it — click its row or card — to see its full detail view, then click **Edit dish**, make your changes, and click **Save changes**. Or click **Remove dish**, which asks you to confirm before anything is actually deleted (and offers a one-tap Undo immediately afterwards).

The form validates as you type: blank fields, negative prices or costs, non-whole sales or waste figures, values above sensible ceilings (£100,000 for price or cost, 1,000,000 units for sales or waste), and a name that's already in use on your menu are all caught before a dish can be confirmed. A £0 price, £0 cost or 0 sales figure is accepted and handled cleanly — you'll never see NaN, Infinity or a misleading percentage.

5. How the numbers are calculated

For each confirmed dish:

Figure	Formula
Monthly revenue	$\text{selling price} \times \text{units sold}$
Monthly ingredient spend	$\text{ingredient cost} \times \text{units sold}$
Gross profit (per sale)	$\text{selling price} - \text{ingredient cost}$
Gross margin %	$\text{gross profit} \div \text{selling price} \times 100$
Food cost %	$\text{ingredient cost} \div \text{selling price} \times 100$
Monthly gross profit	$\text{gross profit} \times \text{units sold}$
Monthly waste cost	$\text{units wasted} \times \text{ingredient cost}$

Waste is pure cost with no offsetting revenue — wasted units were never sold, so waste cost isn't part of gross profit or food cost %. It's tracked separately and only affects Net profit and Break-even revenue on the Profit control screen (section 12).

If a dish's selling price is £0, its margin and food cost percentages show as a dash (—) instead of an error — there's nothing meaningful to divide by, so the app says so rather than guessing.

6. Menu benchmarks and targets

Two menu-wide figures are used to judge every dish, and two optional targets let you override them:

- **Average units sold** — the plain arithmetic average of monthly sales across your confirmed dishes.
- **Overall food cost / benchmark** — not a simple average of each dish's food cost, but your total ingredient spend as a percentage of total revenue. Your highest-revenue dishes pull this figure more than low-revenue ones, the same way they pull your actual bottom line.
- **Target food cost % (Overview screen)** — optional. When set, every dish's food cost is measured against your chosen target instead of the menu's own average — useful once you know what your concept should be running at, rather than judging dishes only against each other.

- **Target gross margin % (Insights screen)** — a separate, independent setting. It powers the Margin target table only (section 9) and never changes the food-cost benchmark used for categories, opportunities or the Action plan.

All of these recalculate live as you add, edit, confirm or remove dishes, and need at least one confirmed dish with revenue behind it to produce a figure.

7. Dish categories

Every confirmed dish falls into one of five categories, shown as a coloured pill wherever it appears:

Category	Meaning
Loss	Ingredient cost is higher than selling price, so every sale currently loses money before overheads. Checked first, and can appear even with a single dish on your menu.
Optimise	Sells above your average units sold, but its food cost is above benchmark. High volume and high cost together — a small fix goes furthest here.
Grow	Margin is above your menu average, but sales are below average. The economics work; demand is the gap.
Review	Behind average on both sales and margin. Worth deciding whether to fix, reprice, or drop.
Strong	Above average on both sales and margin. Protect it.

A dish only becomes Strong, Grow, Optimise or Review once there are at least two confirmed dishes to compare it against; before that (or with a single dish and no Loss condition) it's shown as needing more menu context.

8. The Profit Map

On the Menu screen, the Profit Map plots every confirmed dish by relative sales (horizontal) and relative margin (vertical) against your menu averages, colour-coded by category. Click or tap a dish's dot to open its detail view directly.

Directly below it, Sales mix shows what share of total gross profit your top-selling dishes generate, and whether your most popular dishes tend to carry higher or lower margins than the rest of the menu — a useful check on whether volume and profitability are pulling in the same direction.

9. Insights: opportunities, price candidates and margin target

Insights covers every confirmed dish as its own card, ranked most urgent first: Loss, then Optimise, then Grow, then Review, then Strong.

Where a dish's food cost is above benchmark, its card shows a Potential improvement — the modelled monthly value (and, on the dish's own detail view, the annualised $\times 12$ figure too) of cutting ingredient cost or portion size to bring that dish in line. Each figure carries a confidence read (Limited data / Worth investigating / Strong signal) based on menu size, sales volume and how large the gap actually is — always labelled as modelled potential, not guaranteed profit.

Price-change candidates, a separate table on the same screen, lists dishes with proven demand (selling at or above your average) where price is well below what their food cost supports — a different lever on the same underlying gap, showing the suggested new price and its own modelled monthly potential. A price rise is generally lower-risk on a dish that's already selling well than on a slow seller.

Margin target lets you set a target gross margin % (or use your menu average) and lists every dish falling short of it, with the monthly shortfall in £ — a second, independent lens alongside the food-cost-based opportunities above.

10. Scenarios — testing a change

Reach Scenarios either from the sidebar (desktop) or by clicking **Test a change** on any dish's detail view, which arrives with that dish pre-selected. On the Scenarios screen itself you can also pick any confirmed dish from the dropdown.

Three independent test fields — price, ingredient cost and units sold — each show the modelled monthly change in gross profit for that change alone. A Current vs proposed table then shows the combined effect of all three changes together, alongside a plain-language recommendation and a “which change matters most?” ranking of the three levers by impact. Nothing here changes your actual menu — to apply a scenario for real, edit the dish itself and confirm it.

On a phone or narrow window, Scenarios doesn't have its own bottom-navigation icon — reach it via a dish's Test a change button (see section 19, Troubleshooting).

11. Action plan

The Action plan turns every flagged dish into one concrete, checkable step — picking the single best lever for that dish rather than listing every possible angle, so it reads as a to-do list you can work through top to bottom:

- Loss dishes — fix or remove, always first.
- A price rise, where the dish already sells at or above menu average and the food-cost gap is large enough to matter — shown in preference to a cost cut on the same dish, since raising price on a proven seller is typically lower-risk.
- A cost cut, where a price rise isn't applicable but the dish is still above benchmark.
- Grow dishes — give more visibility (menu placement, staff recommendation).
- Review dishes — investigate and decide whether to rework, reprice or remove.

Each item shows its modelled £/month impact and can be ticked off as done; completed items persist on this device until the underlying dish is edited or removed, at which point that step is cleared automatically since it no longer applies.

12. Profit control: labour, overheads, waste and net profit

Profit control brings the whole business's costs together against your menu's gross profit:

Figure	What it covers
Overheads	Rent, utilities, insurance and anything else you add manually as a name and a monthly £ amount. Stored on this device only.
Labour	Tracked separately from overheads so labour-specific ratios can be calculated. Enter a monthly labour cost and, optionally, monthly staff hours.
Waste	Every dish's monthly waste cost (units wasted × ingredient cost), listed dish-by-dish. Not part of gross profit, but deducted here.
Net profit	Gross profit – overheads – labour – waste.

Figure	What it covers
Break-even revenue	The monthly revenue needed, at your menu's current profit margin, to cover overheads, labour and this month's waste.
Labour cost %	$\text{Labour cost} \div \text{total revenue} \times 100$.
Sales / labour hour	$\text{Total revenue} \div \text{monthly staff hours}$.
Prime cost %	$(\text{Ingredient cost} + \text{labour cost}) \div \text{total revenue} \times 100$ — the standard restaurant benchmark; 60% or below is typically considered healthy, though it varies by segment.

Break-even revenue only shows a figure when your menu's margin is positive; a menu that loses money on every sale on average has no meaningful break-even point, so the app shows a dash rather than a misleading negative number.

13. Purchasing analysis

On the Menu screen, Purchasing analysis compares today's ingredient costs against a saved version (pick which one from the dropdown) for every dish that exists in both. It shows the £ cost movement per dish, the monthly impact of that movement at today's sales volume, and flags dishes whose category would have been different under the old cost — so a supplier price rise that's quietly eroded a dish's margin doesn't go unnoticed. Save at least one version (section 15) to start using this.

14. Ingredient library and recipes

Instead of typing a single ingredient cost for a dish, tick **Build ingredient cost from a recipe** instead of entering it directly on the dish form. Add one line per ingredient — name, quantity, unit and cost per unit — and the dish's ingredient cost becomes the sum of every line, shown live as the recipe total.

The Ingredient library (Menu screen) lets you save an ingredient's unit and cost per unit once under a name, then reuse it: typing a matching name into a recipe line auto-fills its unit and cost (without overwriting anything you've already typed on that line). Saving an ingredient under a name that already exists in the library updates that entry — and updating a library ingredient's cost immediately cascades that new cost to every recipe line across your menu that uses the same name, so a single supplier price change only needs to be entered once.

Two recipe lines within the same dish can't share the same ingredient name — combine them into one line with a larger quantity instead; this keeps a recipe's total from silently double-counting an ingredient entered twice by mistake.

15. Menu versions, comparison and historical profitability

Click **Save current version** (Menu screen) to freeze a snapshot of every dish exactly as it stands right now, under a label and timestamp. Up to 20 versions are kept; saving beyond that quietly drops the oldest. A saved version is a frozen copy — editing your live menu afterwards never changes a version you've already saved.

Each saved version can be restored (replacing your current menu with that version's dishes — you'll be asked to confirm first, since this overwrites what's currently on your menu) or deleted.

Compare versions puts any two versions (or a version against your current menu) side by side: dish count, revenue, gross profit and food cost as headline figures, then a dish-by-dish breakdown of what was added, removed, or changed in price, cost or units, with the resulting monthly profit swing for each.

Historical profitability lists every saved version oldest-to-newest, ending with your current menu, so you can see revenue, gross profit, food cost and margin move over time at a glance, with the profit change versus the prior period on each row.

16. Importing and exporting CSV

Import CSV accepts a file with, at minimum, four columns: dish name, selling price, ingredient cost and units sold, in any column order if a recognisable header row is present (for example “Dish”, “Selling Price”, “Ingredient Cost”, “Units Sold”), or in that fixed order if there's no header row.

Every row is validated on the way in against exactly the same rules as manual entry — negative prices or costs, non-whole or negative units sold, blank names, values above the same ceilings used on the dish form, rows with too few columns, and dish names that already exist on your menu or are repeated within the file are all rejected rather than imported incorrectly. Imported dishes start with zero units wasted, same as a manually added dish left blank.

Before anything is imported, a preview shows exactly which rows will be added and a plain-English summary of anything skipped and why, with row numbers matching your actual file so you can find and fix them. Imports are capped at 500 dishes per file; if a file has more valid rows than that, you're told how many will be skipped before you confirm.

Export CSV writes every confirmed dish with both its raw inputs and its calculated figures — gross profit, gross margin %, food cost % and category — so the file is useful in a spreadsheet on its own. An exported file can always be re-imported cleanly.

Export action list (sidebar, desktop only) writes a short CSV of just the dishes currently flagged in the Action plan — dish, status, why it was flagged, and its £ opportunity — for sharing with a manager or accountant without every raw metric column.

Sample Menu.csv, in this folder, is a ready-to-use example you can import to see the format — it's the same menu offered by “Try sample menu” when you first open the app.

17. Printing a report

Click **Print report** in the sidebar (desktop width only — see section 19, Troubleshooting) to open your browser's print dialog with a clean report: your restaurant name and reporting period if you've set them, headline KPIs, the menu health bar, your single biggest opportunity, sales mix, a profitability-beyond-the-menu section (overheads, labour, waste, net profit) where you've entered any of those, historical profitability across your saved versions, and your top Action plan priorities. The on-screen navigation, buttons and modals are excluded automatically, so nothing but the report content prints.

18. Your data and privacy

Everything you enter — dishes, recipes, the ingredient library, overheads, labour figures, targets, saved versions and your restaurant profile — stays in your browser's local storage, on your own device. Nothing is uploaded anywhere, and the app works with no internet connection at all. The save indicator in the top bar confirms your menu is saved on this device; if you switch browsers or devices, or clear your browser's site data, that data won't carry over automatically — export a CSV first if you want a portable backup.

19. Troubleshooting

The page looks unstyled, or buttons don't do anything.

Make sure you extracted the zip fully before opening index.html — see section 2.

My menu disappeared.

Check you're opening the app from the same browser and the same device as before; local storage doesn't follow you between browsers, devices, or private/incognito windows.

A dish won't confirm.

Check the warning message below the dish form — it names exactly what's missing or invalid, including a duplicate name.

No categories or opportunities are showing.

You need at least two confirmed dishes before Strong / Grow / Optimise / Review can compare one against another. A dish priced below its ingredient cost will still show as Loss even on its own.

My CSV won't import.

Confirm the file has at least four columns covering dish name, selling price, ingredient cost and units sold, with no negative numbers. Check the import preview — it lists the exact reason for every row that would be skipped, with the row number from your file.

I can't find Scenarios, Export action list or Print report on my phone.

All three currently live in the desktop sidebar only. Reach Scenarios via a dish's Test a change button; for the others, use a desktop-width browser window.

My saved versions or ingredient library disappeared.

Like your menu, these live in this browser's local storage on this device only — they won't appear in a different browser, device, or private/incognito window.